

COMBAT MINDSET — THE WAY FORWARD

Defining, developing and assuring the human-performance capability Army requires to remain effective in combat.

WARFIGHTING IMPERATIVE

REMAIN EFFECTIVE. **ACT DECISIVELY.**

Army requires individuals, teams and leaders who remain effective and act decisively, persistently, adaptively and ethically under the threat, adversity and uncertainty of combat.



COMBAT MINDSET

Combat-specific expression

▼ enabled by



PERFORMANCE UNDER PRESSURE

Enabling human-performance capability

▼ developed and organised through



ARMY COMBAT MINDSET FRAMEWORK

Organising model

▼ delivered through

Combat Mindset is the combat-specific expression of Performance Under Pressure.

The individual and collective readiness and disposition to remain effective and act decisively, persistently, adaptively and ethically under the threat, adversity and uncertainty of combat in order to achieve the mission.

Performance Under Pressure is the trainable individual and collective human-performance capability to:

- ✓ Prepare for pressure
- ✓ Recover from pressure
- ✓ Maintain performance through pressure

Applicable across combat, command, crisis response, training, garrison leadership and high-risk technical activity.

The Army Combat Mindset Framework is the organising model through which Army defines, develops, integrates and assures the capabilities, products and governance arrangements that enable Combat Mindset.

It organises:

- Doctrinal definitions
- Desired outcomes
- Capability pillars
- Developmental progression
- Products and methods
- Delivery responsibilities
- Governance
- Evidence
- Assurance

CAPABILITY PILLARS



Leadership



Mental skills



Performance cognition



Resilience & recovery



Physical performance



Professional identity & values



Individual & collective exposure to pressure

▼ each product contributes across multiple pillars

TRAINING PRODUCTS AND METHODS

NZALC
Performance
Under Pressure
package

NZDF Psychology
products

COGCON
(Performance cognition)
Developmental product

Scenario &
experiential
training

Physical
conditioning

Structured
reflection &
recovery

Other products
identified in Phase
1 stocktake

Developed across the Prepare – Perform – Recover cycle · Lead Self ▶ Lead Teams ▶ Lead Leaders ▶ Lead Systems

Delivered by approved training establishments, units and existing instructor workforces across Army



GOVERNANCE AND ASSURANCE

- Army Sponsor — strategic sponsorship and policy direction
- COMDT ACS — interim capability integrator
- ACS — framework development and delivery coordination
- HPC — COGCON product steward; performance-cognition adviser
- Layered doctrine, evidence, professional and delivery assurance



PROGRAMME OF WORK — PHASES 0–4

0. Define terms, sponsorship and relationship
1. Stocktake current capabilities, products and evidence
2. Draft the Army Combat Mindset Framework
3. Validate with stakeholders and units
4. Report back — Framework v1.0, November 2026



HARDER TO KILL

Proposed Warfighter Focus tagline — subject to sponsor endorsement